

Cold Email Templates for Gyms and Fitness Studios

10 Proven Outreach Templates to Fill Classes, Win Corporate Clients, and Grow Memberships

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How to Use This Template Pack

This pack contains 10 cold email templates designed specifically for gyms, fitness studios, personal trainers, and boutique fitness brands. Whether you are prospecting corporate wellness partnerships, reaching out to local businesses for group memberships, re-engaging lapsed members, or filling new class slots, these templates give you copy that converts.

Each template includes a subject line, full email body, and a clear call to action. They are organised into four categories: Initial Outreach (first contact), Follow-Up (building the relationship), Break-Up (graceful final attempt), and Re-Engagement (winning back lapsed members or leads).

Fitness is a personal, emotional purchase. These templates are written to connect with that motivation -- health, confidence, energy, community -- rather than leading with pricing or equipment lists.

- Replace all bracketed placeholders [like this] with your specific details before sending
- Best send times for fitness prospects: Monday 6-8am (New week motivation) and Wednesday 5-7pm (mid-week planning)
- Wait 4-5 business days between follow-ups to avoid seeming desperate
- Personalise with the recipient's company name, neighbourhood, or a specific health trend when possible
- Track open and reply rates to optimise your highest-performing templates over time
- Keep daily cold email volume under 40 to protect your sender reputation

Template 1: Initial Outreach -- Corporate Wellness Partnership

SUBJECT LINE: A wellness perk your team at [Company Name] will actually use

Hi [First Name],

I run [Gym/Studio Name] in [Location], and I have been working with companies like [Similar Company 1] and [Similar Company 2] to provide wellness programmes that employees genuinely enjoy -- not the kind that get announced once and forgotten.

Here is what we have seen with our corporate partners:

- Employee participation rates of 60-75% (compared to the industry average of 20% for traditional gym memberships)
- A measurable reduction in sick days -- [Company Name] reported 23% fewer absences in the first six months
- Improved team cohesion from group classes that double as team-building

Our corporate wellness packages are flexible. We offer on-site sessions, discounted studio memberships, lunchtime express classes, and hybrid options that include at-home workout plans. Pricing is structured per employee, and most companies find it costs less than their current wellness budget allocation.

I would love to put together a custom proposal for [Company Name]. It takes about 15 minutes for me to understand your team's needs and put numbers on paper.

CTA: Would [Day] or [Day] work for a quick call? Or if you prefer, reply with your team size and I will send a tailored proposal by email.

WHY THIS WORKS: Corporate clients are the highest-value B2B opportunity for fitness businesses. This template leads with employee engagement data and ROI rather than gym features, speaking the language of HR and operations managers.

1. Research the company's existing wellness initiatives on their careers page before reaching out
2. Reference specific corporate partners (with their permission) to build credibility
3. Offer multiple response options -- a call or an email-based proposal -- to reduce friction

Template 2: Initial Outreach -- Local Business Owner

SUBJECT LINE: Free week for your team at [Business Name]? (No catch)

Hi [First Name],

I own [Gym/Studio Name], just [distance -- e.g., a 3-minute walk] from your [office/shop/restaurant] on [Street Name]. I have been meaning to reach out because I think there is a natural partnership here.

We are offering local businesses a complimentary team fitness week -- unlimited access to all classes and facilities for up to [Number] of your staff, completely free, no credit card, no obligations.

Why? Honestly, our best long-term members come from local businesses. When people train close to where they work, they actually stick with it. And happy, energised employees tend to mention us to their friends and family, which is the best marketing we could ask for.

Our most popular sessions for working professionals are:

- 6:30am Early Riser HIIT (45 min, in and out before 8am)
- 12:15pm Lunchtime Express (30 min, shower included)
- 5:30pm After-Work Strength (60 min, all levels)

CTA: Want me to set up your free team week? Just reply with how many people and I will handle the rest.

WHY THIS WORKS: Leading with a genuine free offer removes all risk for the prospect. The proximity angle makes it immediately relevant, and the class schedule demonstrates convenience.

1. Mention the physical distance between your gym and their business -- proximity is your biggest advantage
2. List specific class times that align with working schedules to make it feel instantly practical
3. The 'no catch' messaging in the subject line addresses the obvious objection before they even open the email

Template 3: Initial Outreach -- New Resident or Mover

SUBJECT LINE: New to [Neighbourhood]? Here is your free fitness starter pack

Hi [First Name],

Welcome to [Neighbourhood]! Moving is one of the most stressful life events, and I know the last thing on your mind right now is finding a gym. But when the boxes are unpacked and you are ready to explore your new area, I would love for [Gym/Studio Name] to be one of your first stops.

We are the [description -- e.g., only boutique strength and conditioning studio / largest independent gym / highest-rated fitness studio] in [Neighbourhood], and we have built something special here -- a community of [Number]+ members who genuinely look out for each other.

To make your transition easier, I have put together a free New Resident Fitness Pack for you:

- 7-day unlimited pass (all classes, all facilities, no restrictions)
- A complimentary fitness assessment and goal-setting session with one of our coaches
- A neighbourhood guide with our favourite local restaurants, cafes, and services

There is no sales pitch attached to this. We find that when people experience what we have built, the decision to join makes itself.

CTA: Ready to claim your pack? Reply 'I'm in' and I will have everything set up for you before your first visit.

WHY THIS WORKS: New residents are actively building new routines and seeking community connections. This email taps into both needs while the neighbourhood guide adds unexpected value beyond fitness.

1. Source new mover data from postal services, estate agents, or welcome-to-the-neighbourhood services
2. The neighbourhood guide is a genuine value-add that positions you as a community connector, not just a gym
3. Time this email 2-4 weeks after the move date -- early enough to catch routine-building, late enough that they are settled

Template 4: Follow-Up -- After Free Trial or Visit

SUBJECT LINE: How was your first session, [First Name]?

Hi [First Name],

I wanted to personally check in after your [class/session/visit] on [Day]. I hope [Coach Name] looked after you and that you got a feel for what makes [Gym/Studio Name] different.

I know that first sessions can be intimidating -- walking into a new gym where everyone else seems to know each other is not easy. But I also know that the hardest part is already behind you. You showed up. That takes more courage than

most people realise.

A few of our members shared what they wished they had known after their first visit:

- 'I wish I had not waited three months to come back after my trial' -- Sarah, member since 2024
- 'The community is what keeps me coming. I have made genuine friends here' -- Marcus, member since 2023
- 'I was terrified of the group classes. Now they are the highlight of my week' -- Priya, member since 2025

If you enjoyed your experience and want to continue, I have reserved a [special offer -- e.g., first month at 50% off / no joining fee / free personal training session] for you. It is valid until [Date -- 7 days from now].

CTA: Ready to keep going? Reply 'Let's do it' or visit [Link] to activate your membership.

WHY THIS WORKS: Post-trial follow-ups are the highest-converting emails in the fitness industry. Social proof from real members addresses the emotional barriers (intimidation, belonging) that prevent conversion.

1. Send this email within 24 hours of their first visit while the experience is fresh
2. Use real member testimonials that address common emotional objections, not just fitness results
3. The time-limited offer creates urgency without being aggressive

Template 5: Follow-Up -- No Response After Initial Outreach (Day 5)

SUBJECT LINE: Quick update for [First Name] -- plus something free

Hi [First Name],

I reached out earlier about [brief reference to original email -- e.g., corporate wellness for your team / your free fitness week]. I know you are busy, so I will keep this brief.

I put together a free resource that I think you will find genuinely useful, regardless of whether we end up working together:

[Choose one based on audience:]

- '10 Desk Stretches to Eliminate Back Pain' -- a printable PDF your whole team can use (for corporate prospects)
- 'The 15-Minute Morning Routine for Busy Professionals' -- our most popular at-home workout guide (for individual prospects)
- 'How to Choose the Right Gym: 7 Questions to Ask Before You Join' -- an honest buyer's guide (for new mover prospects)

No strings attached. I create these resources because they help people, and if that eventually leads to a conversation about how [Gym/Studio Name] can support you further, that is a bonus.

CTA: Want the guide? Reply 'Send it' and it is yours in 30 seconds.

WHY THIS WORKS: Following up with a free resource rather than a repeated pitch demonstrates generosity and expertise. It also gives the prospect a reason to reply that does not commit them to anything.

1. Create 2-3 genuinely useful PDF resources that you can attach to follow-up emails
2. The resource should solve a real problem, not be a thinly disguised sales brochure
3. Track which resources get the most downloads -- this tells you what your audience cares about

Template 6: Follow-Up -- Social Proof and Transformation Story (Day 12)

SUBJECT LINE: [Member Name]'s story reminded me of you

Hi [First Name],

I was not sure whether to share this, but a member's story this week reminded me of our conversation (or my earlier email to you), and I thought it might resonate.

[Member Name] joined [Gym/Studio Name] [timeframe] ago. When they walked in for their first session, they told me they had not exercised in [X years], felt self-conscious about being in a gym, and honestly were not sure they would come back after the trial.

Fast forward to today: [Member Name] has [specific achievement -- e.g., lost 15kg / completed their first 5K / deadlifted their bodyweight / attended 150+ classes]. But here is what they told me mattered most -- 'I have energy to play with my kids after work for the first time in years.'

I am not sharing this to pressure you. I am sharing it because I see this transformation happen again and again at [Gym/Studio Name], and I genuinely believe [First Name] that you could have a similar experience.

The door is always open. If you want to chat about what a realistic plan would look like for you, I am here.

CTA: Reply anytime, or book a free consultation at [Link]. No expiry, no pressure.

WHY THIS WORKS: Transformation stories are the most powerful content in fitness marketing. The emotional outcome (energy to play with kids) resonates more deeply than physical metrics alone.

1. Always get permission from members before sharing their story in outreach emails
2. Lead with the emotional transformation, not just the physical numbers
3. The open-ended, no-pressure CTA works because the story has already done the selling

Template 7: Break-Up -- Graceful Exit

SUBJECT LINE: No hard feelings, [First Name]

Hi [First Name],

I have sent a couple of messages about [context], and I want to be straight with you -- I do not want to be that person who fills your inbox with unwanted emails.

This will be my last message unless you tell me otherwise. Before I go, I want to leave you with three things:

1. Your free trial pass never expires. Whenever you are ready -- next week, next month, next year -- just reply to this email and I will set everything up
2. I publish a free weekly newsletter with workout tips, nutrition advice, and member stories. If you would like to receive it (zero sales content, just value), reply 'Newsletter' and I will add you
3. If someone you know is looking for a gym in [Area], we offer a referral reward -- a free month for you and a free week for them. Just mention my name

I wish you all the best with your health and fitness journey, wherever it takes you.

CTA: Reply 'Trial', 'Newsletter', or 'Goodbye' -- or simply no reply needed. I respect your decision either way.

WHY THIS WORKS: Break-up emails generate the highest reply rates across all industries. In fitness specifically, the 'no expiry' trial pass is powerful because health motivation comes in waves -- many people reply months later when they are ready.

1. Break-up emails in fitness outreach see 2-4x higher reply rates than initial outreach
2. The no-expiry trial pass is a strategic long-term play -- keep these contacts in your CRM
3. Multiple low-commitment response options ensure maximum chance of maintaining the connection

Template 8: Break-Up -- The Honest Ask

SUBJECT LINE: Quick question before I go, [First Name]

Hi [First Name],

I will keep this to 30 seconds of your time.

I have reached out a few times about [context] and have not heard back. Totally fine -- but it would help me improve if I understood why. Would you mind telling me which of these is closest to your situation?

1. Interested but the timing is not right (reply with when would be better)
2. Already found a gym or fitness solution that works
3. The price or location does not work for my situation
4. Your emails were not relevant to what I am looking for
5. I just missed your emails -- let's talk

Honest feedback helps me serve people like you better, and I promise not to use your reply as an excuse to pitch you.

CTA: Reply with a number (1-5), or just ignore this and I will quietly close your file.

WHY THIS WORKS: Asking for feedback accomplishes two things -- it frequently generates replies from people who were not going to respond otherwise, and the data you collect helps you refine your outreach for future prospects.

1. The numbered response format reduces reply friction to almost zero
2. Responses to option 3 (price/location) give you intelligence about market objections
3. Even 'option 2' responses are valuable -- you can ask for referrals or offer to be their backup

Template 9: Re-Engagement -- Lapsed Member Win-Back

SUBJECT LINE: We have not seen you in a while, [First Name]. Everything OK?

Hi [First Name],

I noticed it has been [X weeks/months] since your last visit to [Gym/Studio Name], and I wanted to check in. Not as a sales tactic -- genuinely as someone who cares about your wellbeing.

Life happens. Maybe work got busy, motivation dipped, or an injury knocked you off course. Whatever the reason, I want you to know that your spot in our community is still here.

Since you have been away, we have made some changes you might enjoy:

- [New addition 1 -- e.g., We launched a brand-new yoga studio on the second floor]
- [New addition 2 -- e.g., Our class timetable now includes 6am slots for early risers]
- [New addition 3 -- e.g., We added a recovery lounge with ice baths and infrared saunas]

I also want to offer you a no-strings comeback week. Full access to everything, all classes, no charge, no new contract needed. Think of it as a fresh start.

CTA: Want to book your comeback session? Reply with a day and time that works, and I will personally make sure everything is ready for you.

WHY THIS WORKS: Lapsed members are 5x cheaper to win back than new members are to acquire. The empathetic, non-judgemental tone addresses the guilt and embarrassment that often prevent people from returning to a gym.

1. Send this email after 30 days of inactivity -- waiting longer makes re-engagement significantly harder
2. Highlighting what is new gives them a reason to come back beyond just resuming their old routine
3. The personal touch ('I will personally make sure everything is ready') makes them feel valued, not processed

Template 10: Re-Engagement -- Former Lead Who Never Joined

SUBJECT LINE: [First Name], things have changed at [Gym/Studio Name]

Hi [First Name],

You enquired about [Gym/Studio Name] back in [Month/Year], and at the time it was not the right fit. I completely understand -- timing, budget, and priorities all play a role in these decisions.

But I wanted to reach out because we have evolved quite a bit since then, and what stopped you before might no longer apply:

- [If price was the objection] We now offer flexible pay-as-you-go options starting from [Price]/session -- no contracts, no commitments
- [If class times were the issue] We have extended our timetable to include [early morning/late evening/weekend] sessions
- [If intimidation was the concern] We launched a dedicated beginners programme with small group sessions capped at 8 people
- [If location was the problem] We have opened a second location at [Address], which is closer to [their area]

I am reaching out to [Number] former leads this month to let them know about these changes and offer a complimentary return visit. If you would like to take another look, I would love to welcome you in.

CTA: Reply 'I'll try again' and I will set up your complimentary visit this week.

WHY THIS WORKS: Leads who did not convert often had a specific objection. By addressing multiple common objections with concrete changes, you demonstrate that you listened and evolved. This email works especially well 6-12 months after the original enquiry.

1. Review your CRM notes from the original enquiry to personalise which objection you address first
2. Only mention changes that are genuine -- overpromising will destroy trust on their return visit
3. The 'reaching out to X former leads' framing creates subtle scarcity and makes the offer feel exclusive

Tips for Improving Open and Reply Rates

Cold email in the fitness industry has unique dynamics. People's relationship with exercise is deeply emotional -- tied to self-image, past failures, and aspirations. The most effective fitness outreach acknowledges this emotional landscape rather than leading with features and pricing.

1. Lead with outcomes, not equipment: Nobody cares about your squat rack inventory. They care about having energy after work, fitting into their clothes, and feeling confident. Write about the life change, not the facility
2. Use real member stories in every sequence: Collect 10-15 member testimonials that cover different goals, ages, and starting points. Rotate them through your follow-up emails. Social proof is your most powerful tool
3. Time your sends around motivation cycles: Monday mornings and early January see the highest engagement for fitness emails. Mid-week emails (Tuesday-Thursday) outperform weekend sends by 40%
4. Segment by motivation: A corporate HR manager, a new mum returning to fitness, and a competitive athlete all need different messaging. One template does not fit all -- customise the language for each audience
5. Address the guilt factor head-on: Lapsed members and failed trial users carry guilt about not following through.

Your re-engagement emails should normalise setbacks ('Life happens') rather than inadvertently amplifying shame

6. Offer a low-commitment first step: Free trials, free classes, and free assessments convert dramatically better than discount offers. Remove financial risk entirely for the first interaction
7. Include your personal name and face: Fitness is a personal service. Emails from 'James at FitStudio' with a headshot in the signature outperform emails from 'FitStudio Marketing Team' by 3x
8. Follow up with value, not reminders: Every follow-up should contain something new -- a resource, a story, a market insight, or an offer. Never send an email that just says 'checking in on my last email'
9. Build a referral programme into your email footer: Add a PS line to every email -- 'Know someone who would enjoy a free trial? Forward this email and I will set them up.' Referrals are the lifeblood of gym growth
10. Track and iterate monthly: Review your email metrics every 30 days. Which subject lines got the highest opens? Which templates got replies? Double down on what works and retire what does not

Disclaimer: These templates are provided for informational and educational purposes only. Results will vary based on your market, list quality, and personalisation effort. Always comply with applicable email marketing laws including CAN-SPAM, GDPR, and PECR. Sovereign Digital Agency is not responsible for outcomes resulting from the use of these templates.

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